



Q

What is the recommended dehydrator air temperature for drying fruit leathers like mango puree?

DEHYDRATING AND SMOKING



Adults

ANSWER

140°F

FUN FACT

Maintaining the right temperature helps ensure the fruit leather dries evenly and safely.

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs



Q

Why must jerky be heated to 275°F for 10 minutes after drying?



ANSWER

To kill harmful microorganisms that survive drying

FUN FACT

Post-drying heating is one of two safe methods to ensure jerky safety.

Source: PNW 632 Making jerky at home safely



Q

What minimum internal temperature must hot-smoked fish reach and be held for at least 30 minutes?



ANSWER

150°F (preferably 160°F)

FUN FACT

*Proper cooking during smoking prevents dangerous bacteria like *Clostridium botulinum*.*

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home



Q

What is a pellicle in the context of smoking fish?



ANSWER

A shiny, slightly tacky skin on the fish surface that helps smoke adhere

FUN FACT

Forming a pellicle is crucial for evenly smoked and properly preserved fish.

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home



Q

How long should larger or oily fish pieces be brined before smoking?



ANSWER

About 2 hours

FUN FACT

Proper brining ensures uniform salt uptake and safer smoked fish.

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home



Q

What salt concentration is commonly used in the brining solution for fish smoking?



ANSWER

**1 part table salt to 7 parts
water by volume**

FUN FACT

*This brine usually measures about 60°
SAL on a salometer.*

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home



Q

Why is it important to rinse cured pork belly thoroughly after the curing process when making bacon?



ANSWER

To remove excess surface salt and brine for balanced flavor

FUN FACT

Rinsing does not remove curing salts from inside the meat, only surface residues.

Source: PNW 784 Making bacon at home



Q

What ingredient in dry curing bacon acts as a curing salt to inhibit bacterial growth?



ANSWER

Curing Salt #1 (Prague Powder #1)

FUN FACT

Curing salts contain nitrites which help preserve color and prevent botulism.

Source: PNW 784 Making bacon at home



Q

Why should fish pieces be of uniform size and thickness before smoking?



ANSWER

To ensure uniform salt uptake and cooking

FUN FACT

Uneven pieces may lead to under- or over-salted and potentially unsafe fish.

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home



Q

What is a major food safety risk if homemade jerky is dried at temperatures around 140°F-155°F without further treatment?



ANSWER

Pathogens may survive and cause foodborne illness

FUN FACT

Low drying temperatures create environments ideal for microbial growth without additional heating.

Source: PNW 632 Making jerky at home safely



Q

What is the purpose of conditioning jerky after drying and heating?



ANSWER

To equalize moisture and prevent molding

FUN FACT

Proper conditioning ensures even moisture distribution before packaging.

Source: PNW 632 Making jerky at home safely



Q

What moisture content is desired in properly dried fruits and vegetables for safe storage?



ANSWER

Low enough to prevent microbial growth, typically under 20%

FUN FACT

Moisture removal is essential to prevent spoilage and ensure shelf stability.

Source: PNW 397 Drying fruits and vegetables



Q

Why must smoked fish be stored under refrigeration at 38°F or less?



ANSWER

To prevent growth of harmful bacteria after smoking

FUN FACT

Even properly smoked fish can support bacterial growth if not refrigerated safely.

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home



Q

What is the main reason for adjusting drying times based on altitude?



ANSWER

Lower air pressure at higher altitudes changes drying rates

FUN FACT

Drying longer or at slightly higher temperatures may be needed at high altitudes.

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs



Q

Which of these actions should NOT be done when drying herbs at home?



ANSWER

Dry herbs with wet leaves still attached

FUN FACT

Moisture on herbs before drying can cause mold or spoilage.

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs



Q

What is a primary reason cold-smoked fish is considered riskier than hot-smoked fish?



ANSWER

Cold smoking does not cook or kill pathogens

FUN FACT

Cold-smoked fish requires careful handling to avoid foodborne illness.

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home



Q

How long does it take to dry fruit leather made from mango puree at 140°F?



ANSWER

About 10 hours

FUN FACT

Drying time varies based on humidity but should leave no sticky spots.

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs



Q

Why should fish not overlap during brining for smoking?



ANSWER

To ensure uniform salt absorption

FUN FACT

Overlapping fish pieces can lead to uneven curing and unsafe product.

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home



Q

What happens if dried fruits are not stored in airtight containers?



ANSWER

They can reabsorb moisture and spoil

FUN FACT

Airtight storage extends shelf life by keeping moisture out.

Source: SP 50-587 Enjoying home dried fruits vegetables



Q

Which treatment ensures safe jerky even if using ground meat where bacteria can spread?



ANSWER

**Precooking meat before drying
or heating after drying**

FUN FACT

Ground meat requires extra safety steps due to pathogen distribution.

Source: PNW 632 Making jerky at home safely